PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Acrylic Nails

Ratios and times in [brackets] follow your acrylic brand. Check OSHA and state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No fungus, infection, broken skin or lifting. Medications reviewed.

ALLERGY CHECK

Ask about past reactions to acrylic, gel or glue. Signs of allergy: refer to a dermatologist.

PRE-CARE SENT

Arrive with bare nails; another salon's product noted for removal. Liquid is EMA, never MMA.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Source-capture ventilation on ☐ SDS read and on hand ☐ Nitrile gloves, fresh pair ☐ Implements disinfected ☐ New file, buffer, band or bit ☐ Lidded dappen dish ☐ Self-closing metal bin

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult & screen**	10 min	Check nails and skin. Agree length, shape, design and price.
2	**Sanitize hands**	2 min	Both sanitize hands. Nitrile gloves on. Note any allergy history.
3	**Cuticle prep**	5–10 min	Push back cuticle. Remove non-living tissue only; never cut living skin.
4	**Buff & dehydrate**	5 min	Remove shine lightly with 180+ grit; don't overfile. Dust off, dehydrate.
5	**Tips or forms**	10–15 min	Size tips sidewall to sidewall and blend, or fit forms snugly.
6	**Primer**	2 min	Primer per manufacturer, on natural nail only. Keep it off the skin.
7	**Bead & zones**	20–40 min	Medium-wet bead. Zone 1 free edge, 2 apex, 3 thin at cuticle.
8	**File & shape**	15–20 min	Once set, shape with 100–180 grit. Low speed, no heat spikes.
9	**Seal & finish**	10 min	Buff, cleanse, seal with top coat or polish. Cuticle oil. After photos.
10	**Aftercare & removal**	5 min	Fill in [2–3] weeks. Removal: file off bulk, acetone soak, never pry.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Balanced apex, thin cuticle zone, clean sidewalls
- Dappen dish lidded; never pour liquid back
- No product on skin; wipe the brush, don't flood
- Monomer and acetone are flammable: no flames

MMA liquid is unsafe for nails: FDA calls it inappropriate and many states ban it. Signs: harsh odor, rock-hard, won't soak off. Use EMA liquid from a professional brand; keep the SDS.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Liquid or wet product on skin: wipe off at once, then wash with soap and water.
- Itching, redness or swelling: stop, soak off, refer to a dermatologist. No acrylates until cleared.
- Dizzy, headache or wheezing: stop, fresh air. Call 911 if breathing is affected.
- Heat as product sets: pause and lift the hand; use a wetter bead and thinner layers.
- Liquid in the eye: flush with eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Lifting with a green or dark spot: don't fill over it. Remove, refer if infected.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Liquid · powder · lot	Mix ratio	Tips or forms · size	Shape · length
Primer used	**Ventilation used**	**Skin & nail check**	**Next fill · initials**